

A support agent for Verba in Instagram Direct and a Stripe billing channel

I set Verba up as a separate Deia tenant and run the implementation myself. The agent handles customer requests: app issues, subscriptions, refunds. Instagram from week one. Stripe as its own channel for events and conversations, not as another chatbot inside the Dashboard.

3.2 s

median agent response

92%

successful replies in production

24/7

no weekends, no time off

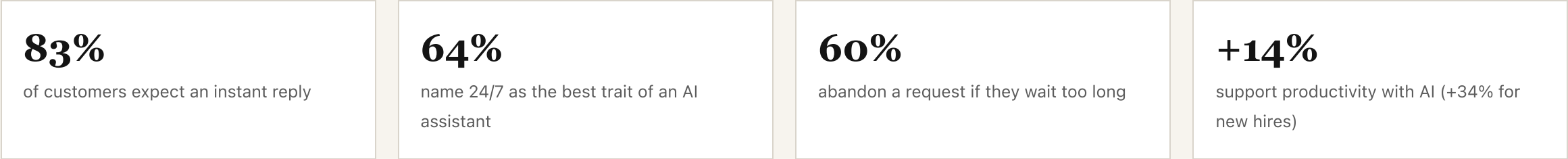
1 tenant

isolated admin, database, prompt

PROBLEM

Customers write when you are not online, and they leave

Evening, weekend, ad spike, another time zone. Support is not 24/7. A refund request and "the app is broken" do not wait until morning. Every minute of silence costs a review, a chargeback, or a cancelled renewal.



Sources: CX research; Harvard Business Review / InsideSales on speed-to-lead; support-AI productivity studies. Verba: 100,000+ users claimed, App Store 4.9 (id 6467481048), support@verba.digital.

PROBLEM

Support is split across four places. None of them talk.

A Verba customer does not pick one official queue. They write wherever the brand is visible. Today that is four disconnected surfaces, each with a different clock and a different person answering.

INSTAGRAM DIRECT

The public brand channel. Bugs, “how do I add a font”, “I was charged twice”, and “refund my yearly plan” land in DM. A late or inconsistent reply becomes a story, a comment, or a 1-star review. The 4.9 rating is an asset at risk.

EMAIL · SUPPORT@VERBA.DIGITAL

App Store listings and receipts point here. Threads sit in a mailbox, outside Instagram history. The same person may already have written in Direct. Nobody sees both threads as one customer.

STRIPE DASHBOARD INBOX

Refund requests and customer messages from hosted receipts and invoices live in Stripe. There is no public Conversations API. This is not Instagram Direct. The team has to sit inside Stripe to read them. Zapier only fires after money is already refunded.

APP STORE / APPLE

Verba bills iOS through In-App Purchases. Apple owns those refunds, not Stripe. If nobody explains reportaproblem.apple.com, the customer writes in Direct and opens a bank dispute anyway.

PROBLEM

The expensive cases are refunds, bugs, and policy drift

APPLE AND STRIPE ARE NOT THE SAME MONEY

Stripe Dashboard only sees charges that actually ran through Stripe (web, B2B, any non-IAP path). Most iOS revenue never appears there. A human, or a naive bot, who says “I refunded your card” on an App Store charge is lying. Apple may already have refused. The next step is a chargeback.

A CHARGEBACK COSTS MORE THAN A REFUND

Unseen Stripe disputes, failed payments, and refund.failed events sit in Dashboard until someone opens it. You lose the payment, you pay the fee, and you still owe the customer an answer. There is no ticket in Instagram when that happens.

HOW-TO REPEATS. REAL BUGS DO NOT.

Fonts, export, teleprompter, captions, SRT, 4K: the site FAQ already answers this. People still DM. Humans retype it at 1am with different wording. A real crash needs device, iOS, and app version. Incomplete reports bounce between support and engineering. Verba ships updates often. Knowledge goes stale between releases.

REFUND POLICY LIVES IN PEOPLE’S HEADS

One teammate refunds a yearly plan. Another refuses. Abuse follows the softer answer. There is no encoded window, amount cap, or “Apple vs Stripe” rule. Night coverage is a second salary. Headcount does not scale with featuring or ads.

Share of Instagram vs email vs Stripe vs Apple IAP is unknown until a short call. That mix decides whether Apple notifications matter more than a Stripe email channel.

SOLUTION

Not a chatbot. A Verba support agent.

DEIA runs full conversations in your brand voice: understands context, reacts to the situation, and initiates the right action, without a manager on shift.

LIVE CONVERSATION

Not buttons and scripts. A real dialogue that adapts to the customer.

INSTANT REPLY

The customer does not wait. An answer in seconds, day and night.

PRODUCT FACTS

Answers from your FAQ and release notes, not a model guessing how Verba works.

BRAND VOICE

Speaks in your style. Knows the product, the tone, and the hard no's.

CLOSES THE LOOP

Does not "inform". Refunds inside policy, sends a portal link, or hands off with a brief.

DOES NOT VANISH

If the customer goes quiet, the agent follows up once, in the context of the thread.

An agent you can see and control yourself

In most products the agent is a black box: “we will configure it, trust us.” In DEIA the logic is text in your admin. You change the refund policy, test it in the sandbox, roll back. No developer for a tone tweak.

PROMPTS

A custom support script: Verba tone, bans, when money can be returned and when it cannot. Version library.

TESTING

Sandbox before go-live: a bug, an Apple refund, a Stripe refund, “I cannot export 4K.”

ADMIN

Instagram threads and Stripe events in one inbox. Handoff to Telegram with a summary.

Yes, we can integrate it.

No, not like Instagram Direct.

Stripe is a billing system with webhooks and a Billing API. Instagram Direct is a messenger with an official inbound and outbound Graph API. Those are different classes of channel. The right build is an adapter, not a copy of Direct.

WHAT YOU WANT	WHAT STRIPE ACTUALLY EXPOSES	VERDICT FOR DEIA
Read Dashboard “Customer messages” as a chat	Inbox in the Dashboard. No public Conversations API	NO API we will not scrape the Dashboard
See a refund request before money moves	Button on hosted receipt / invoice. Often UI-only	PARTIAL email forward plus the agent in IG
Find a customer, invoice, subscription; issue a refund	Customers, Subscriptions, Invoices, Refunds API and webhooks	YES agent tools, official path
Know they cancelled, failed a payment, or opened a dispute	subscription.*, invoice.payment_failed, charge.dispute.*, refund.*	YES event channel in the Deia inbox
Reply in the same Stripe Dashboard thread	No sendMessage. Reply is email or your own channel	YES email channel plus IG, not Dashboard chat

Scraping Stripe’s internal Dashboard API breaks their terms and will rot. It is not in this proposal.

CHANNELS

One agent. Two inboxes in. One inbox out.

CHANNEL 1 · INSTAGRAM DIRECT

Same as every Deia tenant. Official Meta Graph API, OAuth, webhook.
History, typing, story replies, handoff, smart-trigger.

Status: production on the platform. For Verba: a new tenant and a support prompt.

CHANNEL 2 · STRIPE ADAPTER

Not a messenger. Three layers: **tools** (the agent queries Stripe during an IG thread), **events** (webhooks become a conversation in admin), **email** (replies to Stripe receipts arrive as inbound).

Status: custom for Verba. Conversation channels in the core today: ig | tg.

FLOW

Customer writes in Instagram DM, or replies to a Stripe receipt, or Stripe fires a dispute / failed-payment webhook. Deia queues the turn. Claude plus Verba knowledge plus Stripe tools. Reply on the same channel. If needed, Telegram to your team: who they are, what they paid, what they want, what is already done.

Three layers. No fake “Stripe chat.”

	LAYER A · COPILOT	LAYER B · EVENT CHANNEL	LAYER C · EMAIL CHANNEL
Why	Customer DMs “I want a refund.” The agent sees the Stripe payment and acts.	Stripe knocks: dispute, failed payment, refund.failed. A ticket appears.	Customer replied to a receipt or invoice email. That is “Customer Messaging.”
How	Restricted key. Tools: lookup customer, list charges, create refund, cancel subscription, create portal session.	Tenant webhook endpoint. Stripe-Signature. New conversation channel = stripe.	Support email in Stripe Public details, inbound parse, conversation channel = stripe.
Reply	Instagram Direct	Customer email from Stripe, or IG if we already linked them	Email reply in the same thread
Risk	Low. Official API.	Low. Official events.	Medium. Depends on where Stripe forwards replies. We verify on the call.

The agent can return money. Not however the model feels.

On the platform today, refund always goes to a human handoff. For Verba we open the action, with a hard gate in code, not only in the prompt.

AUTOMATIC, IF POLICY MATCHES

- Stripe Customer plus a charge or invoice, not yet refunded
- Inside the window (example: 14 days) and at or under the cap (example: \$29.99)
- No open dispute
- One refund per customer per N days
- Reason on the whitelist: unused, billing error, crash

HUMAN ONLY (TELEGRAM APPROVE)

- Amount above the cap, or a yearly plan
- Repeat request or suspected abuse
- Customer already used generation limits
- Apple IAP: the agent does not refund via Stripe
- Chargeback: dispute process, not a parallel refund

Every create_refund is written to the tenant audit log. Your manager sees charge id, amount, reason. Stripe keys stay in tenant env, never in logs, never in the prompt.

Most iOS refunds never show up in Stripe

Verba on the App Store sells In-App Purchases. That money goes through Apple. Stripe only covers payments that actually ran on Stripe.

IF APPLE BILLED IT

The agent does not call Stripe Refunds. It explains reportaproblem.apple.com, collects Apple ID or email, and tags the thread.
Optional phase 4: App Store Server Notifications V2 (CONSUMPTION_REQUEST, REFUND) as another inbound into the same inbox.

IF STRIPE BILLED IT

The agent looks the customer up, applies policy, refunds or sends a Customer Portal link (cancel renewal, update card), then confirms in DM or email with a 5 to 10 business day statement window.

Without this split the agent promises “refunded to your card” after Apple already said no, and you inherit a dispute. Revenue mix Stripe vs IAP is part of the first call.

Support scenarios, not a generic help widget

PRODUCT

Styles, word vs caption, fonts, SRT, 4K, teleprompter, translation. Answers from your knowledge base, not a guess.

BUG

Collects device, iOS, app version, what fails to export. Typical: a fix path. Novel: handoff with a ready bug report.

BILLING

Where to cancel, why they were charged, next renewal, how to update the card. Portal link for Stripe. A separate script for Apple.

REFUND

Qualify the reason, look up the payment, auto inside policy or a manager button. Plain language to the customer. No raw transaction ids.

LANGUAGE

Mirrors the customer. Verba is a global store. IG and Stripe mail arrive in English, Ukrainian, and others.

ESCALATION

Telegram: who, channel, intent, Stripe customer, amount, the agent's recommendation. Take the thread or approve the refund.

Live dialogues, not a menu of buttons

Instagram · 23:41 · how-to

how do I add my own font?

Select the subtitle, then Edit Style, pick a preset, Edit, Text, Font. You can choose a built-in font or import your own.

imported but it didn't show

That usually means the file is not a supported font. Try .ttf or .otf, then close and reopen the style. If it still does not appear, send me your iOS and app version and I will pass it to the team.

Instagram · 02:17 · Stripe refund

I was charged twice, I want my money back

I can check that. What email is on the payment?

anna@mail.com

Found two charges 3 minutes apart, \$9.99 each. I will refund the duplicate now. It should show on your statement in 5 to 10 business days.

Instagram · 11:04 · Apple IAP

refund my yearly plan

This plan was billed by Apple, so I cannot refund it from our card processor. Fastest path: reportaproblem.apple.com, find the Verba charge, Request a refund. Tell me what went wrong and I can also pass a note to the team.

PROCESS

From the first message to a closed request

STEP 01

The customer writes in Direct, or replies to a Stripe receipt, or Stripe sends a billing event.

STEP 02

The agent reads context, checks Verba knowledge and Stripe (if billed there), and forms a precise reply.

STEP 03

It troubleshoots, explains Apple vs Stripe, or qualifies a refund the way a trained support lead would.

STEP 04

It closes inside policy, or hands off with a ready brief: who, what they paid, what they want.

Channels and integrations: Instagram Direct · Telegram (team) · Stripe adapter · email inbound. Any extra CRM later, via API.

Why DEIA, not a helpdesk chatbot

CRITERION	CHATBOT / HELPDESK AI	DEIA FOR VERBA
Understanding context	Keywords and branches	Full dialogue on Claude
Agent logic	Vendor black box or a flow chart	Custom prompt in your admin
Instagram Direct	Often widgets or unofficial sessions	Official Meta API, isolated tenant
Stripe	Macros / Zapier “new refund”	Tools + webhooks + email as a conversation channel
Refund	A human in the Dashboard	Policy in code + approve in Telegram
Testing before launch	Weak or none	Sandbox with your cases
Data isolation	Shared SaaS	Separate Linux user, database, Claude login

Phases. What turns on when.

PHASE	WHAT YOU GET	TIME	DEPENDS ON
0. Discovery	Stripe inbox screenshot, IAP vs Stripe mix, refund policy, tone, FAQ, who approves.	1 day	Stripe Dashboard (read) and IG Business
1. Tenant + IG	Isolated instance, Instagram OAuth, support prompt, knowledge, Telegram, sandbox, go-live on Direct.	3 to 4 days	Meta App / Page / IG, tone, FAQ
2. Stripe Copilot	Lookup, portal link, gated refund, cancel subscription, audit, Telegram approve.	5 to 6 days	Restricted API key, test mode, written policy
3. Stripe channel	Webhooks become conversations. Email inbound as channel stripe. Inbox filter Instagram Stripe.	6 to 8 days	Webhook secret, support email, proof that replies forward
4. Apple (optional)	App Store Server Notifications: refund and consumption request in the same inbox.	3 to 5 days	App Store Connect key, if IAP is the main pain

I run implementation myself, no subcontract. Phase 1 stands alone and already covers peak Direct. Phases 2 and 3 are custom in the platform core (a new conversation channel).

What is in, and what is out

IN

- A separate Verba tenant on standard provisioning
- A 24/7 support agent in Instagram Direct from week one
- Stripe as source of truth for web billing
- Auto-refund in a narrow corridor, approve above the cap
- Disputes and failed payments as tickets, not a Dashboard surprise
- One inbox and analytics by channel

OUT

- Two-way chat inside the Stripe Dashboard inbox
- Reading every "Refund request" if Stripe does not expose it via API
- Refunding an Apple subscription through Stripe
- 100% auto-close on legal or abuse cases
- WhatsApp as a customer channel (not in the core yet)

Phase 1 likelihood: high (current product). Phase 2: high (public API). Phase 3 email: high after one forward test. Dashboard-parity inbox: low. We do not build it.

Cheaper than a night support shift, and it stays

A LIVE SUPPORT SEAT

- US / EU timezone, weekends, story spikes
- Retraining after every Verba release
- Tone slips, different refund answers
- A missed Stripe dispute is a lost chargeback

DEIA INSTEAD

- One refund policy on every channel
- A reply at 03:00, fewer 1-stars and chargebacks
- A human only on exceptions
- Each app release updates knowledge, not headcount

Even if the agent closes 60 to 70% of how-to and half of billing without a human, that removes the night and weekend layer. Hard cases stay with Verba, already packaged: who, what they bought, what they want.

PRICING

A Verba package, not a \$50 bot

A · INSTAGRAM SUPPORT \$440 one-time, turnkey \$126/mo Tenant, IG OAuth, prompt, FAQ, Telegram, sandbox. First month of the subscription is \$0. Claude tokens billed by Anthropic directly, no Deia markup (~\$20/mo at their rates, traffic-dependent).	B · + STRIPE COPILOT +\$5,800 one-time · tools, gates, approve +\$140/mo Lookup, portal, gated refund, cancel, audit, Telegram approve. Stripe API version support.	C · + STRIPE CHANNEL +\$6,800 one-time · webhooks + email inbound included in B Stripe channel in the inbox, email reply. Apple notifications priced after the call if IAP is the main load.
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Invoiced in UAH at the NBU rate. I recommend starting with A+B. Channel C after we confirm receipt replies land on the support email. Turnkey A+B+C: \$13,040 one-time + \$266/mo.

READY TO TRY?

Write to me. I will put the agent in Direct this week.

01

Fill a 45-minute brief. You show the Stripe inbox. We confirm IAP vs Stripe. We pick A, A+B, or A+B+C.

02

Get the agent. I set the prompt in Verba's voice. We run how-to, Apple refund, Stripe refund in the sandbox.

03

Launch and cover. Instagram goes live. Then I build Copilot and the Stripe channel against your written refund policy.

Want the demo in one step: write in Direct to @deia.agent. You will be talking to the agent. Then I put the same one on Verba.

Before Stripe work I need: a Dashboard screenshot of Customer requests / Messages / Refund requests; IAP vs Stripe revenue mix; a written refund policy; a restricted key (test, then live); the support email on receipts; Instagram Business access; 20 to 30 real replies in Victoria's tone.